


ADMIT ONE

NAME _____ DATE _____ CLASS _____

**Evaluating sources like a pro.** From Victorian spirit photography to modern deepfakes, people have always manipulated visual evidence. The CRAAP test gives you a systematic way to evaluate ANY source — images, articles, videos, or websites.

## 01 PART 1 The CRAAP Test

| | |
|---|---|
| **Currency** | When was it created/updated? Is the information current enough for your needs? |
| **Relevance** | Does it answer your question? Who is the intended audience? |
| **Authority** | Who is the author? What are their credentials? What does the URL tell you? |
| **Accuracy** | Can you verify this elsewhere? Are sources cited? Any errors? |
| **Purpose** | Why does this exist? To inform, persuade, sell, or entertain? Any bias? |

## 02 PART 2 Evaluate Two Sources

Apply the CRAAP test to the sources your teacher provides:

| CRITERION | SOURCE 1 | SOURCE 2 |
|---|---|---|
| Source | | |
| Currency | | |
| Relevance | | |
| Authority | | |
| Accuracy | | |
| Purpose | | |

| CRITERION | SOURCE 1 | SOURCE 2 |
|---|---|---|
| **Verdict: Trustworthy?**<br>Yes / Maybe / No<br>**Why?** | | |

PART 3

## 03 Primary vs. Secondary Sources

| PRIMARY SOURCES | SECONDARY SOURCES |
|---|---|
| Original, firsthand accounts<br>*Examples: photographs, diaries, interviews, letters, original documents* | Analyze or interpret primary sources<br>*Examples: textbooks, documentaries, news articles, biographies* |

**Important:** Primary sources are NOT automatically trustworthy! The Victorian spirit photographs were primary sources (original photographs) — but they were completely fake.

**Quick Check:**

Were the spirit photographs primary or secondary sources? _____

Were they trustworthy? _____ Which CRAAP criteria would have revealed the problem?

MINI MUSEUM CONNECTION

The Mini Museum exhibition includes Victorian optical illusion cards and a stereoscope — both demonstrate how 19th-century audiences were fascinated by visual trickery. Spirit photographer William Mumler exploited both this fascination AND people's grief to sell fake images of deceased loved ones.

The same principles apply today: manipulated images exploit our emotions and our trust in visual "evidence." The CRAAP test helps us pause and think critically.

minimuseumproject.org/exhibitions/seeing-is-deceiving

PART 4

## 04 Comparing Sources

**Which of your two sources was MORE trustworthy? Why?** _____

**What was the biggest "red flag" in the LESS trustworthy source?** _____

SHARE WITH YOUR FAMILY

**Family Challenge:** Find a news story online with your family. Apply the CRAAP test together. Do you all agree on whether it's trustworthy? What criteria did you find most useful?